

are only of the 7200 rpm type. The major advantage with these hard drives is that their data transfer throughput is higher when compared to older 5400 rpm drives, and that helps when you are playing games or watching movies or doing video capturing and editing. 7200 rpm hard drives, in general, are good for all kinds of work.

There is a new type of hard drive that has recently become available: the SATA drive. Again, these drives offer better throughput and also make for less of a cable mess. However, unlike with the IDE cables that most users have, only one drive can be attached to a SATA cable at one time. So you don't have the concept of a master and a slave in machines that have SATA drives.

IDE drives come in ATA 100 and ATA 133 flavours, and ATA 133 drives offer more data transfer bandwidth. But this also depends on the motherboard: if your motherboard only supports ATA 100, the drive will operate at ATA 100. So when upgrading your motherboard, look for a motherboard that supports ATA 133. IDE cables also play an important part, and it is better to chuck the older IDE cables that you may have and use the newer IDE cables bundled with your motherboard. Some IDE cables also have 'ATA 133' printed on them, indicating compatibility with UATA (Ultra ATA) 133 hard drives.

Most new motherboards come with both type of connectors so it depends on you to opt for which type of drive you want to install.

Installing An IDE Hard Drive Is Simple Enough

1. Locate an empty IDE bay in the computer case. Generally, the hard drives go below the floppy drive, and is hidden from view from outside the computer. The only sign that they're inside is the little red LED which indicates the hard drive is working.